

ITA OKPONUNG

Senior Digital Product & Service Designer

United Kingdom · Remote | ita.godwin@gmail.com | 13+ years experience

SUMMARY

Senior Digital Product & Service Designer with 13+ years designing complex internal tools, fintech platforms, and enterprise systems. Currently leads design for internal risk and compliance infrastructure at Paystack, a Stripe Group company. Specialises in turning ambiguous, high-stakes operational problems into coherent, usable systems — from stakeholder research and service blueprinting through to shipped UI and implementation support. BSc Biochemistry; ISO 27001, CRISC, CISA, and Lean Six Sigma certified.

EXPERIENCE

Paystack · Stripe Group 2018 – Present

Sr. Product & Service Designer

Lead Product Designer — Risk & Compliance Operations Dashboard 2020 – Present

- Led end-to-end design of a unified internal SaaS platform consolidating 4 disconnected tools into one system used daily across risk, compliance, and operations teams.
- Ran structured stakeholder research across 3 user groups and produced a 5-swimlane service blueprint that became the shared reference for the design process.
- Reduced case resolution time and automated regulatory reporting that previously required manual assembly; the component library built for this platform became the foundation for two subsequent internal admin tools.

Sr. Product Designer — Merchant Onboarding & KYC Platform 2018 – 2020

- Designed both sides of the merchant KYC process: a progressive-disclosure onboarding flow for merchants and a priority-queued review tool for compliance analysts.
- Replaced free-text rejection notes with structured reasons, reducing analyst effort and merchant re-submission errors.
- Substantially reduced average time-to-live for new merchants and cut KYC-related support tickets after launch.

Wakanow Group 2014 – 2018

Product & Systems Designer

Payment & Fraud Management System 2015 – 2018

- Redesigned payment review and fraud triage grounded in a 4-swimlane service blueprint spanning customer, agent, fraud team, and payment provider flows.
- Designed a risk-scored transaction queue and structured disposition forms, replacing manual free-text review notes with an audit-ready trail.
- Reduced false-positive fraud flags and manual review time per case while increasing analyst throughput and accuracy.

Operational Workflow & Process Redesign 2014 – 2015

- Audited and mapped previously undocumented processes across customer service, operations, and finance, identifying 14 priority failure points.

- Produced Wakanow's first formal service documentation — 3-swimlane blueprints for 6 core workflows — designed to be maintained and updated by team leads.
- Handoff protocols and documentation remained in active use for several years after the project concluded.

Zenith Bank PLC

2009 – 2014

Operations Analyst

- Gathered requirements and produced documentation for digital banking service improvements, including a customer journey redesign spanning 5 phases across 3 core service areas.
- Combined stakeholder interviews with direct observation at branch and call-centre touchpoints to surface friction that interview data alone missed.
- Presented prioritised, impact-estimated recommendations to senior management, directly informing investment in the bank's digital touchpoints.

SIDE PROJECTS

Independent, self-directed design and product work on three mobile apps outside of employment: **Spark Wash** (on-demand car wash booking), **JustBuns** (artisan bakery ordering & delivery), and **ZenRadar** (mindfulness & focus tracking) — end-to-end design from concept through UI.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Product Design — UX/UI, Prototyping, Figma

Service Design — Blueprints, Journey Mapping

Systems & Dashboards — Admin Tools, Data UX

Discovery & Research — User Research, Requirements

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc Biochemistry · ISO 27001 · CRISC · CISA · Lean Six Sigma